Current and To-Be Architecture

Understanding the current architecture is the first step toward designing an effective future state. By documenting and analyzing the existing technical and business landscape, organizations can uncover gaps and challenges that prevent them from meeting business goals. This assessment also creates a foundation for gaining alignment and buy-in across business and technology teams, ensuring clarity on where to focus efforts. Evaluating short-, medium-, and long-term improvements helps determine the most valuable path forward, enabling the development of a strategic roadmap and a well-defined to-be architecture that maximizes return on value.

Technical architecture domains

The four key domains of technical architecture help analyze the customer's current architecture and design the to-be architecture.

- **Data management (D):** Maintains high-quality data that can be accessed reliably and securely
- **Environment management (E):** Establishes the appropriate environment structure and security
- **Application development management (A):** Applies development standards and best practices to reduce technical debt
- **Platform management (P):** Maintains current configurations and manages updates on the platform

Approach to identify the customer's current architecture

Follow the three-step approach to identify customers' current architecture and present the to-be architecture.

1. Identify key stakeholders and interview them, then gather key information and artifacts.
2. Document, analyze, and interpret results in a structured way to evaluate performance, gaps, and redundancies.
3. Document findings accurately and present them through structured diagrams and recommendations for stakeholder validation.

Interview leading practices

Follow the tips below to get the most out of your interviews:

- Ask questions focusing on the four domains of technical architecture
- Keep interviews under one hour
- Include no more than two participants per session
- Ask open ended questions
- Take notes and ask participants for relevant documents

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Approach to document and chart the findings

Use the steps below to document stakeholder feedback and visually represent findings for clarity and alignment:

1. Structure stakeholder feedback and documentation in clear categories for analysis.
2. Use charts or heatmaps to visualize effort levels and highlight focus areas.
3. Provide initial effort estimates and maintain transparency with the customer.
4. Summarize insights in structured charts to ensure clarity and alignment.

Approach for customers already using ServiceNow

If the customer already uses ServiceNow, a separate process is required to define the to-be architecture.

- **Map out the current capabilities:** Document what they have licensed by using a ServiceNow capability map, and visualize gaps and areas of improvement to align with the desired to-be state.
- **Identify hot spots:** From the ServiceNow capability map, highlight areas that need improvement and effort.

Here is an example of a capability map:

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Approach to present the analysis to stakeholders

- Define and agree on a format; find the correct type of output for the organization.
- Make the process transparent; have stakeholders regularly provide their opinion on the results.
- Present the final readout to a prepared audience; discuss the results with interviewees and stakeholders beforehand to ensure there is no miscommunication.

Challenges

- Proceeding without enough executive sponsorship and buy-in
- Only involving IT teams in interviews
- Involving too many people in interviews at once

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